



Bird evolution

Most of the brands change their logo over time, so did Twitter. Read on to find out how the Twitter bird evolved. <http://dgit.in/BirdEvolve>



Startup rejects

Here are some success stories of the startups which were built ground up only after they were denied funding by investors <http://dgit.in/SharTank>

Geek life

IMAGING: ANIL T

WHY SHOULD YOU CARE ABOUT Vulkan API

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“Game” and “Configuration” are two words that are heard together almost too frequently together. Whenever an intriguing new game or the next big instalment of a popular game is announced, the first thing we check is the prescribed minimum system requirements. Apart from the basic details like RAM, Graphics memory, Operating System required, we don’t look into the requirements too deeply.

When it comes to Graphics APIs, most of us have only heard of DirectX and Metal for Mac, that too not as Graphics APIs, but as a piece of software that needs to be present for a certain game to run on our Windows PC or Mac. Chances are that most of us don’t really know their purpose and how the new low level Vulkan API is going to affect them.

The roadmap to the present

Back in the days, when computer games used to be mind blowing due to their mere existence, games were simple enough to run directly off hardware. If you see the game as a piece of code, this code ran directly on the underlying hardware like any other piece of code and required no intermediary. There was little or no reusability between games. The design approach for games was Bottom-Up to make optimal use of the hardware. Even though the 1980s saw the presence of some generic game development tools like ASCII’s RPG maker, Pinball Construction Set etc, most game developers who developed for the arcades used in house game engines to create games for each type of arcade device.

Over time, the underlying hardware gradually got more powerful and consequently complicated. Directly interfacing with the hardware was either no

longer feasible or required a herculean amount of effort for any kind of software developers. The concept of device drivers was introduced as a layer between the hardware and the software application. This was also necessary to make the software function on the variety of devices emerging into the market. A Graphics API (Application Program Interface) is also a specialised driver that is required for communication of standard functions and instructions used by the application and supported by the driver, which in turn acts as a translator for these instructions to be encoded as commands to the hardware.

During the mid-1990s, Id Software’s DOOM and Quake became so popular that other developers preferred licensing core portions of the game and overlay those with their own level designs, characters, gameplay mechanisms, graphics i.e. the actual “content” of the game. Eventu-